

PROPERTY & FACILITY MANAGEMENT

What is the difference?

At SETABASE we offer two complementary services that cover everything a property needs: Property Management and Facility Management. People often mix them up, but they answer two different needs.

IN ONE SENTENCE

Property Management takes care of the **money and the contracts** of a property – it protects the owner's value and income.

Facility Management takes care of how the building **actually works** – it keeps it safe, clean and running.

SIMPLE EXAMPLE: A WATER LEAK

A pipe is leaking in an apartment. The **property manager** reports it, informs the owner and follows the case. The **facility manager** sends the plumber and checks that the repair is done properly.

1. Property Management: managing the asset and its finances

The property manager manages the property on behalf of the owner or the owners' association. This is the administrative, financial and relationship side:

- finding and following up tenants, managing leases and re-renting;
- collecting rent and deposits, paying bills, transferring income to the owner;
- organising owners' meetings;
- annual accounting and rent reviews;
- managing the **common charges**.

WHAT ARE COMMON CHARGES?

In a residence, a compound or an office building, some spaces belong to no one in particular but are used by everyone. Maintaining them costs money, and that cost is shared between all owners – usually according to the size of their home or office. For example:

- **Gardens and green areas:** mowing, trimming hedges and palm trees, watering, replacing plants, sun and sand protection.
- **Security:** guards at the gate, cameras, access badges, barriers.
- **Cleaning:** lobby, stairs, corridors, car park, waste collection.
- **Technical equipment:** lifts, water pumps, generator, air-conditioning of common areas.
- **Pool and gym:** water treatment, equipment maintenance.
- **Lighting and electricity** of paths, car park and lobbies.
- **Building insurance.**

FOR COMMON CHARGES, THE PROPERTY MANAGER:

1. **identifies the needs** by visiting the site and listening to complaints from residents or employees;
2. **prepares the annual budget** and presents it to the owners at the general meeting;
3. **calculates each owner's share**, sends the payment requests and collects the payments;
4. **follows up** with owners who do not pay and keeps the accounts up to date.

2. Facility Management: keeping the building running every day

The facility manager answers the needs that have been identified – directly on site. This is the operational and technical side:

- security and access control tailored to the site;
- cleaning, hygiene, waste and common-area care;
- technical maintenance, repairs and follow-up of works;
- gardens and landscaping, including sun and sand protection;
- IT, gym and operational administration;
- on-site staff, through trusted partners or dedicated teams.

The facility manager selects the right providers, organises the work, plans preventive maintenance to avoid breakdowns and checks the quality of the work.

3. How the two work together

Property Management **finds the problem, prices it and organises the funding**. Facility Management **solves it on the ground**.

The gardens of a compound are yellow and badly trimmed

PROPERTY MANAGEMENT

Receives residents' complaints, gets a maintenance contract priced, has it approved by the owners and adds it to the common charges.

FACILITY MANAGEMENT

Sets up a team of gardeners with a schedule for watering, trimming and sun and sand protection.

In an office building, employees complain about dirt and poor security in the evening

PROPERTY MANAGEMENT

Identifies the problem with the company, plans the cleaning and security budget and shares the costs.

FACILITY MANAGEMENT

Organises daily cleaning, installs badge access control and places a security guard in the evening.

The lift keeps breaking down

PROPERTY MANAGEMENT

Informs the owners, compares quotes and has a maintenance contract approved.

FACILITY MANAGEMENT

Coordinates the technician, follows the repairs and schedules regular maintenance visits.

In summary

	PROPERTY MANAGEMENT	FACILITY MANAGEMENT
Role	Manage the asset and its finances	Keep the building running
For whom	The owner, the owners' association	The occupants: residents, employees
Type of work	Administrative, financial, relationship	Operational, technical
Facing a problem	Spots it, prices it, gets it funded	Fixes it on the ground

The SETABASE advantage: no need for two providers. One team manages both your property and its day-to-day operation – with one point of contact from start to finish.

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